



April 2008

Shocked Subscriber

I have been reading *Digit* for years, and I should tell you that you are the ones responsible for increasing my knowledge about computers and other useful technologies. You have been 100 per cent successful in making a great magazine that gives us all sorts of information at a reasonable price. I decided to subscribe to *Digit* and received my first copy this month. I have a few suggestions:

- 1) You need to improve the packaging of the magazine for subscribers. My magazine came crumpled, because the flimsy cover is of no use.
- 2) I am very disappointed in the way the CD and DVD are packaged for subscribers. I received a cracked CD, but thankfully to my surprise, I found another CD hidden in the Fast Track book. I'm not so sure I will be as lucky next time. Please give subscribers the hard plastic cases that you give newsstand buyers.

You need to update the prices mentioned in the A-List as well—there is a WD Passport drive that has been listed as Rs 6,500 since last year.

Apart from this I have no complaints with *Digit*, and I love every section. If possible, please make the *Digit Diary* one page again, so we can get to know Team *Digit* better. Wishing you a very happy anniversary...in advance!

Clinton Dias

We're glad you enjoy *Digit* and thank you for becoming a subscriber. We're glad you got an extra CD, which saved you from having to wait for a replacement. The problem with the jewel case that we're able to provide to newsstand buyers is that when we package it in subscriber copies, it doubles our courier charges. It's not so much a question of weight, but a question of Indian postal/courier rules. Since the cost of

everything is prohibitive now due to inflation, which you have probably experienced yourself, we are forced to disappoint our subscribers on this one matter.

Team *Digit*

Suggestions Galore

I am regular *Digit* reader, but this is my first mail to you. *Digit* is the best, but you are completely ignoring programming stuff. That would help students like me, as would more Linux stuff. Please reserve two pages for programming and Linux. We also need a guide to help us install additional software in Linux, and demystify things like .tar, .deb, etc. You could also add such tutorials in the form of videos.

Your hardware shootouts are very helpful, but you should provide a long folded page instead of splitting the scoreboard over multiple pages, to help us compare products better.

A Fast Track to programming, covering languages like C++, Java, and Visual Basic, etc., would also be useful.

Your CD/DVD contents are the best, and the interface is awesome, but try and provide something like icon packages, screensavers etc., to spice it up. Also try and give newer movies, released in 50-70s (Ben Hur, Roman holiday, etc.), instead of only 1920s to 1930s movies.

You should also try and give hardware as prizes for your contests, because what would an MBBS or commerce student do with a book called "Guide to Programming" as a prize?

I am eagerly waiting for your anniversary issue, and expecting something different as usual.

Prathamesh

Whoa, that's a lot of suggestions! We will come out with a Fast Track to Programming soon enough, keep your eyes peeled. You will notice that we have already increased the Linux content, and hopefully, we can continue to do so. Providing the hardware test tables in a long sheet is quite impossible, because sometimes we get so many products, that it takes more than 8 pages to list them all. We obviously cannot have a page folded 8 times in *Digit*, because it would cost too much (because of the irregular paper size), and completely ruin the binding. We're glad you like the CD/DVD interface, and we will be adding more features to it soon. As for our prizes, we give books because we feel that the world has forgotten the art of reading. Thankfully, *Digit*

readers do not seem to suffer from this disease, which is evident from the fact that you are reading this magazine. Nothing beats a book. Period. Write in again next month and tell us how you liked the anniversary issue.

Team *Digit*

Even More Suggestions

I am an 18-year old student, and an avid *Digit* reader for over 3 years. *Digit* is a very good tech magazine, with just the right mix of IT content. I still have a few complaints:

- 1. *Digit* is a little too expensive, at least for us students. Why not make an e-mag for people like me, obviously for a much cheaper price tag. This would take care of people like me who don't buy the magazine for the software on offer.
- 2. Secondly, please add more information on IT events (tech expos, gaming expos) going on around the world, and cover it properly. Many of them have gone unreported in *Digit*. Just India-centric information of such events would be nice. For example, we were unaware of competitions like Microsoft's Imagine Cup until you guys reported it.
- 3. Make the A-List bigger to include more categories (budget/mid-range/high-end), and provide information about components like PSUs and cabinets.
- 4. Also try and offer subscriptions without "free gifts" for even cheaper, for people on tight budgets like myself.
- 5. If possible, announce what you will be reviewing the next month, so that we can be prepared to buy issues accordingly.
- 6. What happened to ATI?

Gowtham Nayak

Wow! It's truly inspiring that so many readers are taking time out to give us suggestions. Let's look at them point-wise, as you have mentioned them.

1. As for the price of the magazine, in the ideal world, we would charge you nothing. However, everything costs money—paper, courier charges, DVDs/CDs, printing, salaries... the works. We assure you that we are charging you the bare minimum that we can, in order to be able to deliver the quality content that we do. We do have plans for an e-subscription model, and hopefully we can work out all the chinks to get it to you soon.

2. We do plan on covering as many events as possible. You can rest assured that whether it's via the magazine or our Web site, www.thinkdigit.com, we will try and cover everything we attend.

Write to the Editor

E-mail: editor@thinkdigit.com

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

For subscription queries send an e-mail to help@thinkdigit.com

Inbox



Recreate The Magic

I want to congratulate you for staying India's number one tech magazine. I've been a reader for the past 6 years, and I want to thank my college senior, who introduced me to Digit. In the past 6 years I have missed only 1 or 2 issues, because of the remote place I live in, and my life felt incomplete those months. During this long journey with you, I have never felt the need to complain or suggest anything, because Digit was always perfect. That changes today.

You guys keep innovating, and bringing us new and exciting things, but my suggestion is to go back to your roots. My suggestion is actually something you innovated yourselves! Every issue of Digit has a section called Q&A, that consists of... wait, who am I trying to teach about sections? Anyway, Q&A is something we readers find immensely useful, and Digit already provided us with a book that collected the most common problems that people faced, and gave it to us, long ago. For the life of me I cannot remember which issue it was, but I do remember that it was years ago.

Why not make a Fast Track to Q&A problems and solutions, because in the years that have passed, the problems have changed, so that old book are of no use any more. I think most of us were on Windows 98 when you made that book. I'm even willing to pay extra to get such a book, and I am sure other readers feel the same way, so please give it to us. And in case I haven't said it before, Digit Rocks!!!

Rhitwick Biswas
Tata Consultancy Services

First up, Rhitwick, thanks for sticking with us through all the years. You know, we remember that book for Q&A, and you're right, it was ages ago—over 4 years ago if we remember correctly. We have followed that book up with a Fast Track to Troubleshooting Your PC in 2006, which was pretty much a collection of all the problems that readers have, which we cannot answer in the limited space of the magazine.

We might just give you what you want soon, and make an all new "Fast Track to Troubleshooting Your PC #2", but we cannot commit to when as of now. Stay tuned! We should be able to provide it soon enough.

Team Digit

We will look into the disc casing issue and hopefully put an end to any such problems.
Team *Digit*

Intellectual Property

I was the first amongst my friends to be introduced to computers. I quickly grew in popularity because of my "geek" skills. However, over the years, everyone got a computer, and I wasn't exclusive anymore. I even tried imagining fantastic technologies, but that only lasted a while. All throughout this phase in my life I would see *Digit* gleaming on the magazine stalls, but the cost was prohibitive. Even my parents stopped me from buying my first copy of *Digit*, because they felt I needed to concentrate on my studies, and not waste time and money on magazines.

I stayed adamant, and saved my pocket money to buy my very first *Digit*. That's all it took. I showed it to my parents, and ever since, everyone in our house, including my parents and grandparents, read *Digit* regularly. They even buy me my copies the same day that it's released on the newsstand.

I still have an active imagination, however, and keep dreaming up inventions that I would like to make. However, since I have no means to create them, I find that a few years later, such products are being rolled out already. I wanted to know if there is a way of protecting my ideas. I dreamt up the Vision One Computer Desk several years before it was announced, but someone else beat me to making it.

Govind Nair P.
Kachani Karakulam, Trivandrum

We have to admire your persistence in getting your hands on *Digit*. We're glad to have helped in what ever way we could.

As for patenting your ideas, unfortunately, you can't just dream of flying cars and then go and patent the idea, unless you have a viable way of being able to make cars that fly. At least, you need to show that you are actively researching it, and show some positive results. We would suggest that you focus more on what you can implement, instead of day-dreaming of fantastic technologies. If you are technically qualified, you can look to join research labs, where you will not only get the tools, but the funding to work on such projects.

Team *Digit*

3. The A-List is a quick reference point for the most popular technology categories. Although we may not increase the number of pages, we will try and cram in much more information. And if that plan fails, we can always try and provide it on the discs.

4. You should see more tempting subscription offers soon.

5. We will try and let you know what's coming the next month, but you need to understand that sometimes tests are delayed because of lack of availability of products, in which case our schedules go for a toss. Let's see if we can work this out.

6. ATI cards are very much here. We review them as soon as they're released. Currently, like AMD vs Intel, ATI vs NVIDIA is quite a one-sided battle. Don't worry, we're sure this will not last long, and we're eagerly awaiting AMD/ATI's response. Competition is what makes technology such an exciting industry, afterall.

Team *Digit*

Digit On A Diet?

I am a regular reader of *Digit* magazine and would like to appreciate the effort that Team *Digit* puts in, to create a magazine that makes us tech-savvy and updates us about the latest in the technology world. The only complaint I have with the magazine is that you tend to get slimmer during the February to August period (excluding June). Your disc casing has also become slimmer, and I have seen that all issues before July 2007 had a casing that was 1.2 cm in thickness. After that, the jewel case has become 0.8 cm in thickness, and this results in the DVDs and CDs popping out of their slots and getting scratched or worse, broken. I cannot live without my regular *Digit* software dose, so please make sure you do something about this casing. Also, you guys provide us with great software, but instead of trying to find new software every time, I would suggest you keep providing updates to popular and good software on a more regular basis. I also suggest that you provide Fast Track as an e-book, and make the main magazine fatter. If possible, please also provide us with a trial version of Windows Vista—we have to try it before we buy it!

Kumar Ashok
Jamshedpur

The magazines are always pretty much the same number of pages (except special issues). What does change is the paper, sometimes, which may lead you to believe that there are fewer pages.